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SATURDAY, 15 AUGUST 2026

RIL has announced a tie-up with Rolls-Royce for developing an indigenous combat engine for the AMCA programme
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NDB Plans \$7.5b Funding to Deepen Rupee Lending

The New Development Bank (NDB) plans to channel \$7.5 billion into India over five years, which includes \$5 billion in sovereign lending and \$2.5 billion-equivalent rupee bond scheme, NDB president Dilma Rousseff tells

Deepshikha Sikarwar >> 8

Appliances may go the Quick Way

Large appliances such as refrigerators, TVs and others may get a sales fillip as quick commerce companies such as Instamart and Blinkit initiate talks with their manufacturers to enter the segment, reports **Writankar Mukherjee >> 10**

Wholesale Inflation Eases in July

India's wholesale inflation eased marginally to 9.8% year-on-year in July from 9.9% in both June and May, as softer energy prices offset rising inflation in primary articles, >> 8

THREE STILL MISSING Chamoli Flooded Tunnel: 7 Dead and 19 Rescued

A day after water and debris entered an under-construction tunnel in Uttarakhand's Chamoli, seven people who lost their lives have been identified and 19 of the 22 trapped people were rescued, with many injured. >> 2

\$52.3 BILLION & COUNTING!

FCNR(B) Swaps to Close a Month Earlier due to Gush

Scheme for ECBs, OFCBs will stay open till end of year as planned, says RBI

Our Bureau

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has advanced the deadline for mobilising foreign currency non-resident (bank) deposits by a month to August 31, from the originally announced September 30, citing higher-than-expected foreign currency inflows. RBI received \$52.30 billion through FCNR(B) deposits until August 13, the latest update showed.

"Based on the encouraging response to the swap facility for FCNR(B) deposits and resultant forex inflows, it has been decided that the swap facility for FCNR(B) deposits will be available only for deposits mobilised till August 31," RBI said. "The swaps under this facility, that is, FCNR(B)

Making Waves



deposits, may be availed with RBI till September 11, 2026." However, the swap scheme for external commercial borrowings (ECBs) and overseas foreign currency borrowings (OFCBs) will continue until December 31, as planned, RBI said.

Balance of Payments Slips into Over \$88 Deficit in Q1 >> 8

Contrary to Gov Remarks >> 11

'Phuket Flight Lost Hydraulics for Secs'



Up in the Air

Phuket to Delhi flight lost hydraulic control across three independent systems for about five seconds

Pressure drop caused elevators, ailerons to stop responding to pilot commands

Experts describe incident as 'rarest of rare'

Initial assessment indicates no human trigger

Airbus asks Air India to check if genuine failure or glitch

Arindam Majumder

New Delhi: The Air India Airbus A320 flight from Phuket to New Delhi, which rapidly lost around 300 feet of altitude on August 4, injuring 24 people, briefly lost hydraulic control across all three of its independent systems, leaving pilots struggling for control for a few seconds, the initial assessment of the flight data recorders by Airbus, reviewed by ET, showed. It is yet to be ascertained whether the hydraulics failed or it was a spurious

warning caused by a faulty wire or sensor. Airbus has asked Air India to physically check one of the hydraulic pressure switches to determine if it was faulty and sent a spurious signal. The incident was termed "rarest of rare" by pilots and engineers familiar with the A320, and may invite scrutiny of one of the most widely used aircraft in the world. IndiGo and Air India together operate more than 500 A320 family aircraft, with around 1,300 on order.

Non-responsive Elevators, Ailerons >> 11

SDTT CURBS NOT LIFTED

SDTT Tells Tata Sons about Lack of Quorum for Tuesday's AGM

Clarity on status of meet likely by Mon

Kala Vijayraghavan, Rashmi Rajput & Maulik Vyas

Mumbai: The Maharashtra Charity Commissioner has not lifted curbs on the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SDTT), one of the two principal trusts that majority-owned Tata Sons, putting in jeopardy the Tuesday annual general meeting (AGM) of the holding company of India's biggest conglomerate, people aware of the developments told ET.

Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT), the other principal controlling trust of Tata Sons besides SDTT, has informed Tata Sons that the Trusts do not have the required quorum for the AGM.

Officials close to Tata Trusts said it has informed Tata Sons about the lack of quorum but can't mandate Tata Sons to not hold the AGM.

"They can convene by law but will have to adjourn anyway," an official aware of the developments said.

Top officials close to the matter said even if the AGM isn't held for a lack of quorum, exiting Tata Sons chairman N Chandrasekaran could continue as a director until a valid AGM is held.

Not Moving HC for Relief >> 11

DEFENCE FORAY BY RELIANCE

RIL to Partner Rolls-Royce for Fighter Engine

Tie-up for indigenous combat jet plane; aerospace gas turbine complex on cards

Our Bureaus

New Delhi | Mumbai: Reliance Industries (RIL) on Friday announced a rare foray into the defence sector, partnering with British engine maker Rolls-Royce to offer capabilities for the design, development, manufacturing and delivery of an indigenous combat engine for India's advanced medium combat aircraft programme.

The proposed alliance will combine Rolls-Royce's expertise in advanced propulsion and engine technology with RIL's manufacturing, technology and execution capabilities, the companies said. The Mukesh Ambani-led conglomerate has largely stayed away from the expanding defence industry that's witnessing a deepening private footprint. However, RIL owns majority stake in a manufacturer of military and non-military drones. It was also original partner in an abandoned plan to produce French Rafale fighter jets in India in the 2010s.



End-to-end Capability >> 11

TO INVEST \$100M IN COUNTRY OVER 10 YRS

Kohler Finds India Maximalist

Indians prefer splashy bathrooms to the minimalist designs favoured in some other countries, said David Kohler, chairman and CEO of Kohler Co, tells **Sagar Malviya >> 10**




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AUG 17: ENUMERATION BEGINS IN SNOW-BOUND AREAS OF FOUR STATES & UTS; FEB 2027: NATIONWIDE EXERCISE

Govt Notifies 40-Question Census 2027; Caste to Be Recorded With SC/ST Status

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: The Registrar General of India (RGI) on Friday notified a 40-question schedule for the second phase of the Census 2027, including, for the first time an open-ended question on caste for all respondents, apart from the existing enumeration of Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs). The notification, issued by the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India, Mr. Nitin Kumar Narayan, places "Scheduled Caste (SC)/ Scheduled Tribe (ST)/ Caste" as Question No. 10 in the Population Enumeration schedule. Officials added that the caste field will be an open column, allowing enumerators to record the caste or sub-caste exactly as declared by the respondent. The format was retained after the pre-test for the Population Enumeration phase, conducted from July 1 to 20 across 16 States and Union Territories. During the exercise, respondents other than SCs and STs were asked to state their caste, with enumerators recording the responses in the open



IDENTIFICATION AND SERVICE-RELATED INFO



Enumerators to seek demographic, socio-economic and ID details, including Aadhaar, mobile, voter ID and passport numbers

column. The notification significantly broadens the range of information to be collected during Census 2027. Along with demographic and socio-economic details, enumerators will seek identification and service-related information, including

Aadhaar numbers, mobile numbers, voter ID numbers, passport and driving licence details, wherever applicable.

The exercise will begin on August 17 in Ladakh and snow-bound areas of Jammu and Kashmir, Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh, ahead

of the main enumeration scheduled across the rest of the country in February 2027.

The 40-question schedule covers basic demographic information such as name, age, sex, marital status, spouse's name, nationality, religion, caste or tribe and details of parents. It also seeks information on education, including literacy and digital literacy, attendance at educational institutions and the highest level of education attained. The Census will collect language data, including respondents' mother tongue and other languages known to them. Employment-related questions will cover whether a person worked during the preceding year, occupation, industry or service sector, class of worker and whether the respondent is seeking employment. Information on travel to the workplace will also be recorded.

Migration will form another key component of the enumeration, with questions covering place of birth, previous place of residence, reasons for migration, duration of stay at the current location and permanent residential address.

NDRF, CISF & SDRF LEAD RESCUE EFFORTS

Chamoli Tunnel Tragedy: 7 Dead, 3 Missing as Rescue Ops Continue

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: A day after water and debris entered the under-construction THDC tunnel in Mayapur (Peepalkoti) in Uttarakhand's Chamoli district, 19 people were rescued out of around 22 people reported to be trapped inside the tunnel. While the incident claimed seven lives, search operations are currently underway to trace the three missing persons. 12 persons, who were rescued, have received injuries.

The incident occurred in the tunnel around 7 pm on Thursday when landslides and subsidence caused debris and water to fill half of the tunnel, trapping workers inside, according to a report of the Uttarakhand State Disaster Management Authority.

10 injured persons have been admitted to the district hospital, Gopeshwar, while one injured person Rohit Pandey (Bihar) is undergoing treatment at Base Hospital, Srinagar. Ten injured persons are Sunil (Chhattisgarh), Harbil Gudia (Tamil Nadu), Nistar Bhingra (Jharkhand), Vinod Kawar (Jharkhand), Dina Begara (Jharkhand), Khela Ram (Jharkhand), Subeg Singh (Punjab), Tilakraj (Himachal Pradesh), Chandan Kumar



(Bihar), and Pen Singh (Chhattisgarh). Govind Mandal of West Bengal was discharged after treatment.

Seven deceased persons have been identified as Pradeep Panwar (Tehri Garhwal, Uttarakhand), Mukesh Singh (Chamoli, Uttarakhand), Durlabh Sharma (Uttarakhand), Vijay Hansda (Uttarakhand), Jitendra Kumar (Uttarakhand), Lokeshwar (Chhattisgarh), and Bhuneshwar (Chhattisgarh).

The three persons, who are reported to be missing, are Lukas Topno (Jharkhand), Chetan Poy-

am (Chhattisgarh), and Devnath (Chhattisgarh).

Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami landed in Chamoli on Friday to personally supervise the rescue operation. Rescue operations have been undertaken by NDRF, CISF and SDRF at the site of the incident. The base hospital (Srinagar) and AIIMS (Rishikesh) have been kept in alert mode for proper treatment of the injured persons.

The TRT tunnel of THDC's Vishnugad-Pipalkoti Hydro Electric Project is approximately 3 kilometre long.

I-DAY EVE ADDRESS TO THE NATION

President Murmu Assures Youth on Exam Reforms

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Addressing the nation on the eve of India's 80th Independence Day, President Droupadi Murmu termed the country's youth as its 'most valuable asset', underlined the significance of 'Vande Mataram' as a song of the masses in the Swadeshi movement and termed the suspension of the Indus Waters Treaty a 'decisive step in the interest of our nation'.

The President's address emphasised that the country's young population, comprising 65 percent of the demographic below the age of 35, remains its 'most valuable asset' emphasising that the youth of our country are 'talented, committed, and skilled'.

Her address comes against the backdrop of recent student agitations over public entrance examinations. President Murmu said that just as the government and society must remain united to ensure national security, everyone must contribute through joint and concerted efforts to 'safeguard the present and future of students'.

Highlighting that public examinations serve as 'gateways to the opportunities for our students,' President Murmu detailed comprehensive steps are being undertaken by the Government to overhaul the examination ecosystem.

She reassured the youth that the overarching objectives of these reforms are 'to completely curb the use of unfair means in public examinations, make the examination system more transparent, more secure, and more trustworthy for the youth.'

Alongside, the President also noted the significance of the song 'Vande Mataram' in the freedom struggle, pointing out how during the Swadeshi Movement, Vande Mataram became a 'song of the masses'.

The Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026, which grants Vande Mataram equal statutory protection as the National Anthem was passed by the Parliament in the just concluded monsoon session.

President Murmu also praised the Armed Forces for precision strikes during Operation Sindoor, noting it sent a firm message to terrorists and those who support them, 'that no matter where they hide, they will have to face the consequences of their actions'.

She also termed the suspension of the Indus Waters Treaty 'with the country that harbours terrorism' a 'decisive step in the interest of our nation, especially the farmers'.

President Murmu further drew attention to how despite global warfare and instability India's economy remains the fastest-growing, with growth expected to be 'more than twice the average global growth rate.'



BCI WITHDRAWS NALSAR ENROLMENT BAR OVER CJI PROTEST

'It's Between Me and Students', Says CJI Kant Slamming BCI Circular Against NALSAR Students

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: The Apex Court on Friday strongly disapproved of the Bar Council of India's (BCI) now-withdrawn order that no law student of NALSAR Hyderabad's 2026 batch would be allowed to enrol as advocates on account of their campaign against Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant.

Heading a three-member bench CJI Kant slammed the BCI's move. "Naturally, this is absolutely uncalled for. It's a dialogue between students and me. Who are they (BCI) to raise an issue? This is totally uncalled for. In my student days I have been actively involved in student activities. Assuming,

even if they are wrong, they have a right to protest. BCI doesn't have any business," CJI Kant verbally remarked.

The remarks were made after Senior Advocate K Parameshwar mentioned the matter this morning before the bench.

Notwithstanding that the BCI withdrew the notice, the Bench issued notice on the plea and made it clear that no punitive action should be taken against NALSAR or any of its students or faculty or any other national law university by the BCI.

"No punitive action shall be taken against students or faculty of any national law university/law

university... The pending circular has been withdrawn. Be that as it may, let a counter affidavit be filed within two weeks. No punitive action is to be taken against students of NALSAR in respect of the incidents mentioned in the subject letters," the Bench ordered.

Speaking for the bench, CJI Kant added "Even in young days somebody makes a wrong statement that doesn't mean they don't have the right to protest. Please tell all the students (of NALSAR) to get enrolled, join Supreme Court bar, we will empower them for legal aid cases. This will be the befitting answer to all those who caused impediment in their professional career."

ON INDIA'S TOURISM MAP

50 Villages of Tribal Freedom Fighters to Showcase Tales of Valour, Sacrifice

Nidhi Sharma

New Delhi: From Matho in Leh to Thondarnad in Wayanad and Vedchi in Surat to Jorai in Assam - India is set to put 50 tribal villages on the tourism map through tales of valour and sacrifice of our tribal freedom fighters.

The Centre has identified 50 villages across India where tribal freedom fighters hailed from. The long-forgotten tales of India's freedom struggle will be curated and then recreated through museums and memorials in the villages. Before development activities are plan-

ned, baseline surveys will be conducted in the villages. This will entail collecting data on socio-economic parameters, infrastructure status including road connectivity and status of government schemes. This surveys will be followed by preparation of implementation



plans. According to sources, the government plans to initiate documentation of tribal freedom fighters history, which will include oral history and traditions. Apart from development of museums and memorials, the implementation plans will include interpretation centres and other cultural infrastructure. A senior official, who did not wish to be identified, told ET, "The villages will be developed in entirety including saturation of all government schemes." About 20 lakh per village will be allocated and all government schemes will be integrated.

A beginning will be made with 11

villages. These include Bhagwan Birsu Munda's Ulihatu village in Jharkhand, Munshi Abdul Sattar's Matho (Ladakh), Raja Shankar Shah's Ram Nagar village (Madhya Pradesh), Sonakhan of Shaheed Veer Narayan Singh (Chhattisgarh), Nadimpalem village of Gam Gantam Dora (Andhra Pradesh), Kumran Bheem's Jodeghat village (Telangana), Thalakar Chandu's Thondarnad (Kerala), Joya Taosen's Jorai (Assam), Bhagoji Naik's Nandur Shingote village (Maharashtra), Rendo Majhi's Urladani village (Odisha) and Dashedibahen Kanjinah Chaudhari's Vedchi (Gujarat).

1,057 Police, Fire, Home Guard, Civil Defence Personnel Get Gallantry, Service Medals

New Delhi: A total of 1,057 personnel from the Police, Fire, Home Guard and Civil Defence (HG&CD), and Correctional Services have been awarded Gallantry and Service Medals on the occasion of Independence Day 2026, the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) said.

Medal for Gallantry (GM) is awarded on the ground of a conspicuous act of Gallantry in saving life and property or in preventing crime or arresting criminals, the risk incurred being estimated with due regard to the obligations and duties of the officer concerned.

A total of 301 Medals for Gallantry (GM) have been awarded. Out of 301 Medals for Gallantry, 272 Police Personnel and 29 Fire Service personnel have been awarded GM, respectively. Among the majority of the 301 Gallantry Awards, 197 personnel from Left Wing Extremism-affected areas, 51 personnel from Jammu & Kashmir region, 12 personnel from North-East and 41 personnel from other regions are being awarded for their gallant action.

President's Medal for Distinguished Service (PSM) is awarded for a special distinguished record in service, and Medal for Meritorious Service (MSM) is awarded for valuable service characterised by resourcefulness and devotion to duty. A total of 92 President's Medals for Distinguished Service (PSM) have been awarded. —OPB

KARUR STAMPEDE TRAGEDY

SC Stays Madras HC Order Scrapping Govt Jobs to Victims' Kin



Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: The Apex Court on Friday stayed the Madras High Court's recent decision to quash the State government's decision to give jobs on compassionate grounds to the family members of the 41 persons killed in the September 2025 Karur stampede. A division bench comprising Justices JB Pardiwalla and K Vinod Chandran passed the interim order on a plea moved by the Tamil Nadu government. The Bench observed that an unfortunate incident had led the government to offer employment to the victim families. "An unfortunate incident happened. The government has

decided to compensate them. Should government not give employment?" the Bench verbally remarked.

Last month the Madras High Court had held that the appointments could not be sustained since public employment must be made in accordance with Articles 14 and 16 of the Constitution.

The High Court had passed the judgment on a clutch of petitions challenging the government's decision to offer employment to the families of the 41 persons who died in the September 2025 stampede at a Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) rally in Karur. The case is presently being investigated by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI).



Fugitive drug kingpin Virender Singh Basoya, in white, being escorted by Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) personnel as he is produced before the Rouse Avenue court, in New Delhi, on Friday - PTI

Poliloquy R PRASAD



SC Quashes Case Against RG for Calling Savarkar a British Collaborator

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: The Apex Court on Friday quashed a criminal complaint and summons issued against Leader of Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi over certain remarks he made against Hindutva ideologue Vinayak Damodar Savarkar.

Gandhi had reportedly described Savarkar as a collaborator with the British and further stated that Savarkar received a pension from the British. Acting on a criminal complaint filed against him, a local court in Uttar Pradesh had issued a summons to Gandhi. Aggrieved, he moved the Supreme Court seeking to quash the summons.

A division bench comprising Justices Dipankar Datta and Shree Naga on Friday allowed Gandhi's plea after noting that the criminal proceedings lacked a required sanction under the law to prosecute Gandhi in this case.

"We have heard learned counsel for parties. In affidavit filed by respondent State of UP there is no disclosure of sanction having been granted. In such view of matter, orders passed by Magistrate shall be quashed," the Bench said.

Gandhi was facing charges under Sections 153A (promoting enmity) and 505 (public mischief) of the Indian Penal Code (IPC) in a complaint filed by advocate Nripendra Pandey.

Pandey had initially approached a local Magistrate in UP seeking registration of an FIR against him for his remarks on Savarkar. Pandey raised a grievance over remarks Rahul Gandhi made on November 17, 2022 during his Bharat Jodo Yatra when he referred to Savarkar as a collaborator with the British.

The complainant claimed that these remarks were made with the intent to incite hatred in society. Pandey also claimed that Mahatma Gandhi had previously recognised Savarkar as a patriot.

In June 2023, the Magistrate dismissed Pandey's complaint, prompting Pandey to challenge the same before the sessions court.

The sessions court allowed the plea and remanded the matter back to the magistrate court. Thereafter, in December 2024, Gandhi was summoned in connection by a Lucknow Magistrate.

The magistrate court observed that Gandhi had said Savarkar was a British servant who received a pension. These remarks had spread hatred and ill-will in society. Therefore, the trial court found a prima facie case against Gandhi and directed him to appear before it.

KARNATAKA REGULATION OF USE OF GOVERNMENT PREMISES AND PUBLIC PROPERTY BILL, 2026

BJP Sees Public Property Bill as Effort by Cong to Stifle RSS

Govt says bill creates legal framework for using govt land, buildings, parks, roads, grounds, other public assets

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: Karnataka is set to introduce legislation regulating the use of government premises and public property by private organisations, a move the Opposition BJP has described as an attempt to target the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS). Home Minister Priyank Kharge said the proposed Karnataka Regulation of Use of Government Premises and Public Property Bill, 2026, would create a legal framework for the use of government land, buildings, playgrounds, parks, roads and other public assets. Kharge, on Friday, rejected allegations that the bill was aimed at the RSS, saying it does not name any organisation, political party or NGO. He said the government was acting in line with Supreme Court and High Court directions on regulating



public spaces. "If you take permission, and I take permission, anybody else also has to take permission," Kharge said, urging the Opposition to debate the bill in the Assembly and point out any shortcomings. Bengaluru South MP Tejasvi Surya said the proposed legislation was "clearly an attempt to target the RSS" and argued that the Constitution protects the right to form associations and organisations. He said he and other advocates will challenge the legislation in court if it becomes law. The proposed bill seeks to give statutory

backing to a government notification following a Cabinet decision in October last year requiring prior permission for events and activities at public places. The decision followed a letter by Kharge to then chief minister Siddaramaiah seeking restrictions on RSS activities, including shakhas and baithaks, at government-aided schools, public parks, playgrounds, government-controlled temples and archaeological sites. Kharge had alleged that such activities promoted hatred and raised concerns over RSS cadres carrying sticks at public places without police permission.

WILL MEET CM, SEEK WITHDRAWAL OF NOTIFICATION: VIJAYENDRA

BJP Opposes Gutkha Ban, Says It Will Hurt Areca Nut Growers

About 1.5cr families are dependent on areca nut for their livelihood, says BJP

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: The opposition BJP on Friday opposed Karnataka's one-year ban on gutkha, saying the move could hurt areca nut growers across eight districts. About 1.5 crore families are directly or indirectly dependent on areca nut for their livelihood, BJP state president BY Vijayendra said. He said he



would meet chief minister DK Shivakumar and seek withdrawal of the notification. Karnataka cultivates areca nut across more than 676,000 hectares, out of the over 949,000 hectares nationally, and produces about one million tonnes annually, accounting for a large share of India's 14 million tonnes of output, Vijayendra said. He also said that Karnataka accounts for Rs 465 crore of the Rs 600 crore goods and services tax (GST) collected nationally from areca nut-related business. Vijayendra said areca nut has health benefits, citing Ayurveda, and accused the government of encouraging liquor sales by setting targets for officials while banning gutkha. "If this decision is not withdrawn immediately, we will have to face a difficult situation in the future," he said.

BAN FOLLOWS CM'S WARNING Karnataka earlier this week prohibited the manufacture,

storage, transportation, distribution and sale of gutkha, pan masala and other products containing tobacco and nicotine for one year, citing public health concerns. The Food Safety and Drugs Administration issued the notification under Section 30(2) (a) of the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006 and Regulation 2.3.4 of the Food Safety and Standards (Prohibition and Restrictions on Sales) Regulations, 2011. The ban came weeks after Shivakumar warned the pan masala and gutkha industry that his government would prohibit such products if authorities found intoxicating substances being added to products sold to consumers.

MASOUD PEZESHKIAN'S FIRST VISIT TO DELHI AS PRESIDENT

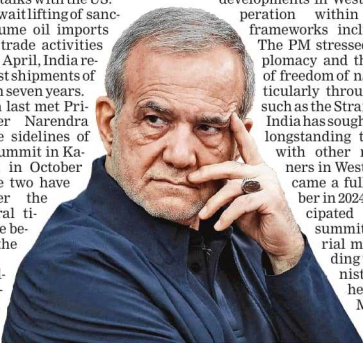
Iran Prez to Visit India for BRICS Summit Amid Hormuz Tensions

Chabahar Port likely to be a key focus of India-Iran discussions during Iranian president's visit in Sept

Dipanan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian will travel to Delhi to attend the 18th BRICS summit on September 12-13, said people familiar with the matter. This will be his maiden trip to India as the President of Iran, and it will take place in the backdrop of the US-Iran war and blockade of the Strait of Hormuz which has impacted maritime traffic and disrupted critical energy supplies to India. The two sides have been engaged in intense diplomacy since March to secure safe passage for commercial vessels carrying energy supplies meant for India through the Strait of Hormuz. During

the September visit, India would like to firm up its arrangement with Iran on the Chabahar Port, said a person with knowledge of the matter. Pezeshkian is also expected to brief India on peace talks with the US. India will await lifting of sanctions to resume oil imports and launch trade activities with Iran. In April, India received its first shipments of Iranian oil in seven years. Pezeshkian last met Prime Minister Narendra Modi on the sidelines of the BRICS summit in Kazan, Russia, in October 2024 and the two have spoken over the phone several times since the beginning of the war. The visit follows an earlier formal invitation



extended by Prime Minister Modi during a phone conversation with the Iranian President in late June. In that call, according to Iranian readouts, the two leaders discussed regional developments in West Asia and cooperation within multilateral frameworks including BRICS. The PM stressed dialogue, diplomacy and the importance of freedom of navigation, particularly through key routes such as the Strait of Hormuz. India has sought to balance its longstanding ties with Iran with other regional partners in West Asia. Iran became a full BRICS member in 2024 and has participated in previous summits and ministerial meetings, including the foreign ministers' gathering held in Delhi in May this year.

NO LINKS TO ANY BANNED ORGANISATION OR EXTREMIST GROUP ESTABLISHED SO FAR

Badal Attack: Accused Blamed SAD Govt for Punjab Drug Crisis, says Police

Our Political Bureau

Mumbai: The accused in the attack on Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) chief Sukhbir Singh Badal in Nanded was allegedly angered by the drug menace in Punjab and blamed the previous SAD government for failing to tackle the



SAD chief Sukhbir Singh Badal discharged from a private hospital -PTI

problem, police said. Authorities have so far not established any connection between him and a banned organisation or an organised extremist group. Jaspal Singh (62) allegedly told the police that the SAD administration had turned a blind eye to drug trafficking, leaving thousands of youngsters affected by drug abuse. Police are examining his claims and statements to establish the exact motive behind the attack and whether anyone else was involved. Singh was produced before a local court in Nanded on Friday for custody. "Initially he said he was angry about the drugs (problem) in Punjab. But the exact reason for the attack will come out only after a detailed investigation. We have also not come across any gang connection or criminal background of the attacker," Nanded superintendent of police Neelabh Rohan said. According to people familiar with the matter, Singh also spoke about "their government" being in power and failing to win the public's trust, suggesting that a political grievance may have been another factor behind the attack. Maharashtra Anti-Terrorism Squad and central investigating agencies questioned Singh till late Thursday night. Badal was attacked at around 1.50 pm on Thursday as he was leaving Mata Sahib Gurdwara in Nanded. A police sub-inspector from the Special Protection Unit shielded Badal during the incident. Both sustained minor injuries.

'FROM PERSON CLAIMING LINKS TO ROHIT GODARA GANG' NCP's Zeeshan Siddique Gets Death Threat

Mumbai: NCP leader Zeeshan Siddique approached Mumbai Police on Friday after allegedly receiving a death threat from a person claiming to be associated with gangster Rohit Godara, an official said. Siddique received a voice note on his mobile phone from a Portugal-based number while he was abroad. After returning to Mumbai, he approached Bandra police and lodged a complaint. -PTI

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Har Pal Aapke Saath

CELEBRATING FREEDOM

The spirit of Independence. The power of progress

Independence is more than a historic milestone. It is an enduring promise, the freedom to aspire, the opportunity to progress and the ability to shape a better future. For Uttar Pradesh, that promise is increasingly reflected in the pace and scale of development witnessed over the past nine years. Today, Uttar Pradesh

stands at an important juncture in its own journey of transformation. Over the past nine years, the state has witnessed a broad-based push across infrastructure, industry, education, agriculture, tourism, energy and social development, strengthening the foundations of a more confident and aspirational Uttar Pradesh.



ALL PHOTOS: DPMR, UP GOVT



UTTAR PRADESH: DRIVING INDIA'S GROWTH STORY

Strong law and order

- » A policy of zero-tolerance against crime and criminals has been effectively implemented
- » After the establishment of police commissionerates in 7 major cities, there has been a qualitative improvement in policing, grievance redressal, and crime control
- » Since 2017, there has not been a single incident of communal riot or caste conflict

Women safety

- » Mission Shakti Centres have been established in every police station across the state. Several police personnel have been trained for their functioning
- » All women-related crime units at police stations have been brought under Mission Shakti Centres
- » After the establishment of Mission Shakti Centres, a decline in crimes was observed from September 2025 to June 2026
- » Incidents under the POCSO Act decreased by 17.01%, kidnappings of women and children decreased by 6.13%, dowry deaths decreased by 43.32%, and domestic violence decreased by 13.30%
- » Allotment of 9,172 women beats by appointing a total of 19,400 women police personnel in all the police stations of the state

Expressway state

- » Compared to just 2 expressways in 2017, Uttar Pradesh is progressing towards becoming a state with 22 expressways (10 operational and 12 under different phases)

- » 60% of the country's total expressway network passes through Uttar Pradesh

Aviation infrastructure and MRO

- » Currently, 17 airports are operational, including 5 international airports and 7 under development
- » With the launch of Noida (Jewar) International Airport, Uttar Pradesh has become the first state in India with 5 international airports
- » Air connectivity is being provided to more than 80 destinations, both domestic and international

Health & wellness

- » Uttar Pradesh is the leading state in the country, having issued 58.5 million (5.85 crore) Ayushman Cards so far
- » A total of 6,468 hospitals have been empanelled under the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana
- » 45 government medical colleges, 2 by ESI and 36 private medical colleges, a total of 83 medical colleges are operational

Uttar Pradesh as an MSME hub

- » Chief Minister Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan launched in 2024-25 to promote self-employment among educated and trained youth by helping them establish new micro-enterprises
- » So far, 1.81 lakh youth have benefited, generating employment for over 4,51,775 people
- » Under the Mukhyamantri Yuva Swarajgar Yojana, 37,280 youth have been supported to establish units in the industrial and service sectors, with ₹940.86 crore distributed

- as margin money, generating employment for 2,98,240 people

Defence Industrial Corridor

- » One of the two Defence Industrial Corridors being developed in the country is being established in Uttar Pradesh
- » Approximately 2095.10 hectares of land has been acquired to develop a total of six nodes: Jhansi, Chitrakoot, Lucknow, Aligarh, Agra, and Kanpur
- » Investments of ₹39,804 crore and direct employment of 60,332 people are estimated in relation to the signed MoUs
- » Currently, a total of 9 entrepreneurial organisations, including DRDO, BrahMos Aerospace, Adani Defence Systems and Technologies, have started production of defence equipment

New era of investment & employment

- » In 9 years, private investment proposals worth more than ₹50 lakh crore have been received. 1.10 crore employment opportunities will be created
- » In accordance with the mantra of 'Reform, Perform, Transform', 36+ sectoral policies have been implemented, and the single window system 'Nivesh Sarathi' portal has been created
- » So far, 4 Ground Breaking Ceremonies have been organised, through which projects worth more than ₹15 lakh crore have been brought to the ground. 60 lakh job opportunities have been created

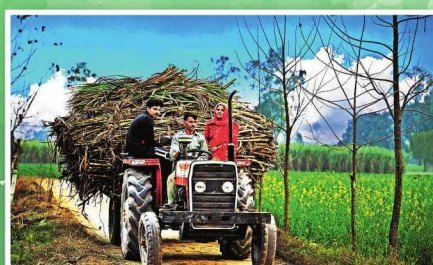
- » Ground Breaking Ceremony @5 with projects worth ₹7.5 lakh crore is proposed

One District One Product (ODOP)

- » Under the (ODOP) Financing Assistance Scheme, loans amounting to ₹967.60 crore have so far been disbursed to 21,401 beneficiaries, generating 3,48,873 jobs
- » Through the Skill Upgradation and Toolkit Scheme, 1,61,473 beneficiaries have been provided with training and toolkits. Under the ODOP Common Facility Centre (CFC) Promotion Scheme, 30 CFC projects across 24 districts have received final approval
- » 8,742 artisans and entrepreneurs have been provided financial assistance amounting to ₹82.64 crore under the ODOP Marketing Promotion Scheme

Prosperous farmers

- » Under the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi Yojana, over ₹1.03 lakh crore has been transferred in 22 equal installments to 3.12 crore farmers
- » Under the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana, from 2017-18 to 2025-26, compensation of ₹5,966.87 crore has been paid to a total of 353.14 lakh insured farmers
- » Under the PM Kusum Yojana, from the financial year 2017-18 to 2025, a total of 91,100+ solar pumps of various capacities have been installed in farmers' fields



Google Debuts New Gemini Flash Amid Top AI Model Delay

Bloomberg

Alphabet's Google released another installment of its workhorse Gemini Flash artificial intelligence model, but didn't say when it would release its most powerful AI model, Gemini 3.5 Pro, which has been hampered by delays.

The new Gemini 3.7 Flash model outperforms its predecessor in coding tasks like debugging, and is more capable at generating deployable, production-ready code on the first try, Google said in a blog post on Thursday. The models can also complete app production in fewer prompts, deliver a better developer experience and lower the price of tokens needed to operate it, the company added.

Google's AI productivity agent, Gemini Spark, will be powered by 3.7 Flash starting on Thursday.

In keeping with its Frontier Safety promises, Google said it added stronger safety features to Gemini 3.7 Flash, including blocking malicious hacking and dangerous chemical, biological, radiological or nuclear misuse without getting in the way of safe, helpful work.

Despite expanding its Gemini Flash lineup, Google has struggled to keep pace with rivals OpenAI and Anthropic PBC in the high-stakes race to build the most advanced AI models. Delays to Gemini 3.5 Pro have left investors questioning Google's roadmap, especially in commercially important areas like AI coding. The uncertainty around timing for its next flagship model has intensified broader questions about whether the tech giant can outpace its competitors and successfully convert its massive AI investments into market-leading tools and services.

Chief executive Sundar Pichai said during the company's last earnings call that Google was aiming to release models at a faster clip, and said it is already spending considerable computing resources to train the upcoming Gemini 4 model.

The new Gemini 3.7 Flash model outperforms its predecessor in coding tasks

Govt Mulls Single-window Clearance for Space Sector

DoT, MIB, IN-SPACE likely to share a common interface under the system

Kiran Rathee

New Delhi: The government is considering introducing a single-window clearance system for the space sector to improve ease of doing business and reduce timelines in getting approvals from different ministries.

The National Single Window System (NSWS) already facilitates various government approvals for businesses, and it is being explored whether the same can be expanded for approvals in the space sector, officials told ET.

A single-window interface has already been discussed and in-principle agreed upon by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MIB) and space regulator Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe) where the



applicants are common to all these departments, they said.

"The framework for implementing inter-departmental single window interface for space-based systems has been discussed but not all ministries are on board yet," an official said on condition of anonymity.

To grant approvals for space-based businesses, including fore-

ign players, various departments and ministries have to work in tandem. Apart from DoT, MIB and IN-SPACe, the Department of Space, ministries of home and external affairs as well as law enforcement agencies are consulted for different things.

For satellite communication services like the ones to be offered by Starlink, Jio Satellite, inter-ministerial approval also needed

Jio Satellite, an inter-ministerial approval is needed from the security point of view.

"Getting approvals from different ministries and departments takes a lot of time and sometimes it becomes repetitive," a second official said. With a single-window platform, tracking the application becomes much easier.

To start with, approvals for IN-SPACe can be applied and tracked through the single window system and soon other ministries can be integrated with the platform, the person said.

The government had earlier sought comments from the space industry around ways and suggestions for improving ease of doing business. The industry had highlighted the cumbersome regulatory process and longer time periods for getting approvals. Establishing a single-window platform was a key demand of the industry.

India Eyes Data-sharing Pact with US to Tighten CSAM Crackdown

India-US legal differences on CSAM reporting spur need for a formal framework

Suraksha P

Bengaluru: India may need to negotiate a formal data-sharing arrangement with the United States to strengthen investigations into online child sexual abuse material (CSAM), rather than relying primarily on notices and criminal proceedings against technology companies' local subsidiaries, multiple experts and stakeholders told ET.

Two years after the Supreme Court clarified that reporting suspected CSAM to a foreign organisation does not absolve a platform of criminal liability under Indian laws for failing to notify local authorities, US social media platforms such as Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp, YouTube, X and Snap continue to send such reports only to US-based National Centre for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC), the sources said.

The platforms argue that US law constrains them from directly



sharing automated CSAM detection data with foreign authorities, requiring such reports to be routed through NCMEC.

This conflict between Indian reporting requirements and US laws makes the case for a formal data-sharing agreement, experts said. There is also disagreement over how quickly NCMEC sends its CyberTipline reports to the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C), the designated body to receive these reports in India.

"Reports are made available to the appropriate law enforcement

agency in, on average, less than 15 minutes from the time we receive it," NCMEC said in response to ET's queries. But people close to I4C said there may be delays of months. Resolving that inconsistency would require a joint discussion involving platform, NCMEC and I4C, experts said. The issue was raised in a recent Parliamentary Standing Committee meeting.

"In our view, the discussion did not fully reflect the legal and operational realities that platforms and I4C have been discussing privately," one of the sources said.

One proposal is to provide supplementary tips: platforms would not send the actual content directly to local law enforcement or I4C, but could share metadata relating to reports from India that were submitted to NCMEC.

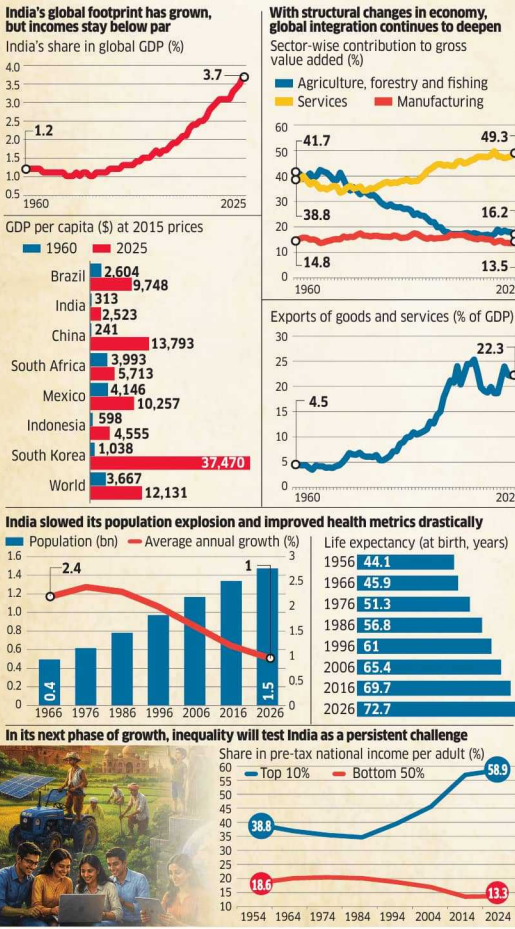
"Our legal advisers have identified a red line where we cannot violate the US Stored Communications Act. They are also aware of Indian law," a platform executive told ET on condition of anonymity. "We have, therefore, tried to focus on the underlying objective, which is supporting investigations, through supplementary tips and by seeking clarity on NCMEC-to-I4C response times. Those proposals have not yet produced an agreed solution."

I4C, Meta, X and Snap did not respond to ET's queries until press time Friday.

India's Growth Story, and its Challenges—in Numbers

India celebrates its 80th Independence Day today, marking eight decades of transformation since 1947. Over the years, the economy has evolved dramatically—from rising incomes and a larger global footprint to deeper integration with the world economy and a shift towards services. India has come a long way, but significant challenges remain.

Anoushka Sawhney takes a look.



EDTECH FIRM RETAINS FY27 GROWTH TARGET

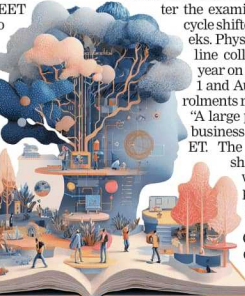
PhysicsWallah Narrows Q1 Net Loss 31% to ₹88.3 cr, Revenue Rises to ₹1,054 cr

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: Edtech firm PhysicsWallah's consolidated net loss narrowed 31% to ₹88.3 crore in the April-June quarter from ₹127 crore a year earlier, as operating revenue rose 24% to ₹1,054 crore, led by its online business. It retained its FY27 guidance of more than 30% revenue growth, full-year net profitability and profitability in its offline business, saying a delayed NEET cycle had shifted enrolments into subsequent quarters.

"An annual growth target of 30% does not mean we will deliver the same growth in every quarter. The second and third quarters are stronger, and we remain on track to deliver what we are targeting," Prateek Maheshwari, cofounder and whole-time director, told ET.

Reported earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (EBITDA) turned positive



at ₹52 crore from a ₹21 crore loss, helped by other income nearly doubling to ₹109 crore. Excluding that income and after accounting for lease payments, the company remained loss-making at ₹44 crore, though the loss narrowed from ₹69 crore.

NEET DELAY SHIFTS ENROLLMENTS

Online NEET collections declined 28% during the quarter, while offline NEET enrolments were down 19% at June-end after the examination and result cycle shifted by five to six weeks. PhysicsWallah said online collections grew 51% on year between July 1 and August 13, while enrolments rose 82% after July. "A large part of our offline business comes from NEET. The enrolment cycle shifted by five to six weeks, so we expect that growth to come through in the next quarter," CEO Alakh Pandey said in the post-earnings call.

DeepSeek Raises Flagship AI Models' Prices Ahead of IPO

DeepSeek is steeply raising the prices for its flagship V4 models ahead of a potential initial public offering, even as the low-cost provider's rates remain well below those of its major artificial intelligence rivals.

A new peak-hour pricing will increase the Chinese company's rates by more than four times from the current levels, according to a post on its website. The price increases will take effect on August 16.

Going forward, users will pay \$1.32 for 1 million output tokens during peak hours, and half that during off-peak hours, for the DeepSeek-V4-Flash model. That's up from \$0.28 for 1 million tokens previously. A token is a measure of the work an AI model does to digest information and produce results. The increase suggests DeepSeek is placing more focus on profitability as it eyes a stock-market debut, though the move still leaves its cost per token below that of main competitors. Chinese rival Moonshot prices its Kimi K3 at \$15 per million output tokens, while Anthropic's Fable 5 service charges \$50. **Bloomberg**

ASPH APEEJAY SURRENDRA PARK HOTELS

APEEJAY SURRENDRA PARK HOTELS LIMITED

CIN: L85110WB1987PLC222139
Registered Office: 17 Park Street, Kolkata – 700 016
Tel.: +91 33 22499000, E-mail: investorrelations@asph.in, Website: www.theparkhotels.com

STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

S. No.	Particulars	Quarter ended				Year ended
		30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026	
		(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	
I	Revenue from Operations	166.78	183.70	154.25	707.28	
	Other Income	4.79	0.75	2.28	5.72	
	Total Income	171.57	184.45	156.53	713.00	
II	Profit before Finance costs, Depreciation and Amortisation expense, Exceptional items and Tax	51.65	53.74	47.67	223.74	
III	Profit before Tax for the period/year	20.20	24.20	22.41	115.60	
IV	Profit after Tax for the period/year	11.49	11.88	13.42	65.72	
V	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face Value per share Re. 1 each)	21.34	21.34	21.34	21.34	
VI	Other equity	-	-	-	1,320.98	
VII	Earnings per equity share of face value of Re. 1 each attributable to equity holders of the parent					
	Basic (₹)	0.54	0.56	0.63	3.08	
	Diluted (₹)	0.54	0.56	0.63	3.08	
		(not annualised)	(not annualised)	(not annualised)	(annualised)	

Notes to unaudited consolidated financial Results

- The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results are available on the websites of BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively and on the Company's website at www.theparkhotels.com.
- The above unaudited consolidated financial results of the Group for the quarter ended June 30, 2026, have been reviewed and recommended by the Audit and Risk Management Committee and approved by the Board of Directors in their respective meetings held on August 14, 2026. The Statutory auditors have expressed an unmodified opinion on these consolidated financial results.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of
Apeejay Surrendra Park Hotels Limited
Sd/-
Vijay Dewan
Managing Director
DIN: 00051164



Place: Kolkata
Date: August 14, 2026

PROMOTERS PLEDGE 6.65% STAKE

Zetwerk Files Updated IPO Papers, Plans to Raise ₹2,600-cr Fresh Capital

Our Bureau

Bengaluru | New Delhi: Contract manufacturing startup Zetwerk has filed the updated draft red herring prospectus for its initial public offering (IPO), through which it plans to raise fresh capital of ₹2,600 crore.

As part of the IPO's offer-for-sale (OFS) portion, founders Srinath Ramakrishnan and Amrit Acharya are each selling shares worth about 1% of the company, while Creovate Innovations Pvt Ltd, the holding entity controlled by them, is selling shares worth about 1.5%. Investors, including Peak XV Partners, Lightspeed and Kae Capital, are also diluting their stake.

Nearly a third of the combined pre-IPO stake held by Zetwerk's pro-



motors and promoter group, or almost 6.65% of the shares, have been pledged, according to the Bengaluru-based manufacturing company's updated draft red herring prospectus, filed on Thursday.

Ramakrishnan and Acharya have pledged 1.05% of the company's equity directly. However, the broader promoter group, which holds 4.81% of the company through Creovate and family trusts linked to them, is heavily encumbered. Of their aggregate holding, 4.80% is pledged, as per the draft IPO filing.

Zetwerk's promoters pledged their shares in September 2025, when they raised debt to invest around ₹600 crore in the company.

Ahead of the IPO, some of these pledged shares are being released. As per the updated draft red herring prospectus, up to 28 million shares held by the founders and nearly 23 million Creovate shares are being released to enable their sale in the OFS component.

Additional shares are also being released only so they can be locked in post-listing, as regulations by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) require. A portion of the remaining pledged shares—those beyond what's needed for the OFS or lock-in—will continue to remain pledged even after listing.

Ramakrishnan currently holds an 8.36% stake in the company, Acharya 7.53% and Creovate 2.19%. The remaining promoter group members, which are the family trusts linked to the two founders, collectively hold another 2.62%.



Shri D K Shivakumar
Hon'ble Chief Minister



Dr. G. Parameshwara
Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister

Wishing everyone
a Happy
80th
Independence Day



**YUVA KARNATAKA
NAVA BHARATHA**

True freedom today means empowering young people to dream without limits, freeing every family from hunger and financial anxiety, instilling confidence in women, and ensuring a life of dignity for every citizen. **Karnataka's Five Guarantee Schemes** are turning these aspirations into reality, bringing renewed hope, security and opportunity to millions of lives.

Inspired by **Mahatma Gandhi's** ideals of '**Antyodaya**' and '**Sarvodaya**', and guided by the constitutional values of **Dr. B. R. Ambedkar**, we are advancing towards '**YUVA KARNATAKA, NAVA BHARATHA**' through the **Karnataka Model of Development**, powered by the energy and aspirations of our youth.



Guarantee Sarkara



Scan and listen to the
Independence Day
message



"To protect and respect our vibrant culture and tradition,"
is a Fundamental Duty of every citizen.
This is affirmed by our Constitution.

CMofKarnataka

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Karnatakavarthe



karnataka information

New Development Bank president says India's growth trajectory creates big opportunities for financing, rejects de-dollarisation concerns

The NDB is a multilateral development bank established by Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa (BRICS) in 2015 to fund de-

NDB is expanding the use of member currencies on both sides of its balance sheet, rais-

tion, nor do we promote local currencies as an alternative to the US dol-

Greater monetary diversification can reduce exchange-rate exposure, mitigate currency mismatches and help deepen domestic capital markets while giving emerging economies more flexibility to respond to external shocks, Rousseff said.

India's development trajectory creates significant opportunities for NDB financing, particularly in transport, water security, clean

The global economy is experiencing a cumulative process of instability that has been building for many years and is imposing extraordinary challenges on emerging markets and developing countries, NDB chief said.

To reverse the fragmentation driven by geopolitical conflict and the weaponisation of economic and financial tools, these countries must in turn deepen cooperation, anchored in a coherent and purposeful multilateralism, Rousseff suggested. "The structural objective must be sustained, inclusive and long-term development, which requires peace and stability."

Networks Enabling Mass Tariffs

India, Canada and the EU, among others are placed in the "Tier-1 Diversified Scale Leader" category which "comprises countries and trading blocs that account for large absolute volumes of China-linked goods while maintaining diversified industrial bases and major U.S. export platforms."

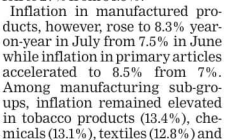
Tier 2 includes Brazil, Indonesia and Malaysia, which allegedly combine significant illegal transshipment volumes with deeper integration into China-linked supply chains. Tier 3 is the largest tier by number of countries including Cambodia, Laos and Myanmar which, as per the report, provide China-adjacent border corridors.

TARIFF ARBITRAGE, CONCERNS
As per the report, tariff arbitrage lies at the heart of this transshipment arrangement and when a Chinese product that faces a high US tariff is routed through a country with a lower tariff rate, that difference simultaneously becomes a loss of revenue for the US.



Food inflation at 19-month high of 6.6% in July from 6.1% in June

Fuel and power remained the lar-



"This was largely led by a broad-based uptick across manufactured food items and most primary food articles barring fruits and vegetables," said Rahul Agrawal, principal economist at ICRA. Looking ahead, WPI inflation is expected to ease below 9.5% in August, he added.

Annual value of illegally transshipped goods pegged in \$40-303 b range

This comes at a time when the U.S. has imposed a 10% tariff on Indian goods under a Section 301 probe on forced labour, and is in the process of enacting a legislation that

"This may form the basis of future investigation against India. Tougher enforcement could mean more inspections, shipment delays, retrospective duties and pe-

India's Q1 Balance of Payments Slips into Deficit

The country's current account deficit (CAD) widened in the first quarter to \$3.1 billion from \$2.9 billion in the year-ago period while the capital

Crude oil import bill rose 26% year-on-year to \$49 billion in the first quarter of FY27

the same period. On the capital account side, the net foreign direct investment grew to \$7.8 billion in the period under review from \$4.8 billion a year prior.

However, a net \$9.6 billion outflow during the quarter on account of the withdrawal of investments by foreign portfolio investors (FPI) from the local markets turned the balance of payments mathematically unfavourable.

India recorded a net FPI inflows of \$1.6 billion in the year prior. Net external borrowing was also at a negative \$100 million against \$5.3 billion surplus in the year-ago period.

Pune: The government has stepped up scrutiny of sugar stocks as prices surge to record highs, with the food ministry seeking consumption data from large industrial buyers and conducting physical checks at mills.

Bulk consumers, including soft-drink and ice-cream makers, sweetmeat sellers and food processors, account for an estimated 65% of India's sugar consumption. The ministry has asked sugar mills to furnish bulk consumer-wise details of buyers to whom 500 metric tonnes or more of sugar was sold annually, either directly or through

agents in the 2025-26 financial year. The move comes as officials conduct physical stock checks at mills. The ministry of consumer affairs has written a letter to the sugar mills to share bulk consumer-wise sugar sales data. "During the physical verification of sugar stocks conducted by this department in various states, it has been observed that, in certain cases, sugar stock which has been sold to bulk consumers was found stored in the godowns of sugar mills. However, such stock was reportedly not reflected in the stock details furnished by the sugar mills in P-2 form," states the letter, reviewed by ET.

period. On the cap-
count side, the net fore-
cast investment grew to
\$1 billion in the period un-
der review from \$4.8 billion a
year prior.
However, a net \$9.6 billion
outflow during the quarter
out of the withdrawal
of investments by foreign
investors (FPI) from
all markets turned the
net of payments math-
ematically negative.
The recorded a net FPI in-
flow of \$1.6 billion in the year-
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wing was also at a negative
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An ISO-9001:2015 & 14001:2015 Company

64886,

Date : 14.08.2026

www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in/

Registration date	Last date of submission
20.08.2026	28.08.2026
20.08.2026	20.08.2026

Manager (Materials)

	Karnataka Soaps & Detergents Limited (A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)	An ISO-9001:2015 & 14001:2015 Company 
Sandal City: P.B No. 5531, Bengaluru - Pune Highway, Bengaluru - 560055. Ph: 080-22164879, 22164886, Website: www.mysorensandal.org E-mail: kSDL.dgmmtls@gmail.com		
Date : 14.08.2026		

TWO ADNOC VESSELS ATTACKED IN HORMUZ
‘Economic Isolation of Iran will be Like Never Before in History’

US to announce measures next week; UAE blames Tehran for ship attack

London | Panama City: Transit through the Strait of Hormuz appeared to grind to a near standstill on Friday after two more ships were attacked there and the United States said it could maintain a naval blockade of Iran indefinitely. Two vessels from the state-owned Abu Dhabi National Oil Company were attacked transiting the strait on Thursday evening, UAE state news agency WAM reported. The United Arab Emirates government blamed Iran, which made no immediate comment. Nine vessels passed through the narrow waterway at the entrance to the Gulf on Thursday, up from five on Wednesday but below the average for August of 12, according to ship-tracking company Kpler. There were no visible crossings by vessels seen early on Friday, according to ship-tracking data. Some ships may pass through undetected with their transponders off, but the figures are nowhere near the more than 130 ships that daily traversed



the Strait of Hormuz before the war launched by the US and Israel on Iran in February. “Alongside the threat to energy infrastructure in the region, Iran’s ability to restrict shipping through the strait is its main source of leverage in negotiations,” said Torbjorn Solvett, principal West Asia analyst with risk intelligence company Verisk Maplecroft. **‘INDEFINITE’ NAVAL BLOCKADE** US defence secretary Pete Hegseth told reporters the US military has the capability to maintain a naval presence in the region to enforce its retaliatory blockade of Iran, which has inflicted severe economic damage on the country. “Indefinitely—the United States Navy can maintain a blockade like that because we’ll rotate ships in and out, as we have, and we’ll continue to,” Hegseth told reporters during a trip to Panama. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said the US planned to inflict more financial damage on Iran. “Watch this space for more announcements coming next week because we are going to apply measures like have never been seen in the history of economic isolation on a country,” he said in an interview on Newsmax’s “Rob Schmitt Tonight” programme.

MAGA Abroad US Navy Gets Nod to Build Ships Overseas

US President Donald Trump has allowed the Navy to build ships overseas and ordered it to abandon a complex system for launching jet fighters from its aircraft carriers and instead return to using steam catapults, the White House said on Thursday. Trump signed a national security memorandum directing the change, which would require the fourth vessel in the Gerald R. Ford class of aircraft carriers to abandon the Electromagnetic Aircraft Launch System (EMALS) used on the first three vessels. The design change is expected to cost taxpayers hundreds of millions of dollars. Huntington Ingalls is the primary contractor building Ford-class aircraft carriers. Huntington’s shares were up slightly in after-hours trading in New York. As of March 2026, the USS Gerald R. Ford, the lead ship in the new class of carriers, had completed 36,863 EMALS launches, according to Pentagon documents. The design change will occur on the Doris Miller, the fourth ship in the planned Ford class. The keel for the Doris Miller is slated to be laid by the end of 2026 with delivery anticipated by the Navy in early 2034. Trump has frequently criticized the Navy’s electromagnetic launch system as being more expensive and not as effective as steam catapults. **Reuters**

US-China Tech Decoupling in Fast lane with POTUS’ 100% Levies on Drones

The Trump administration is imposing tariffs of as much as 100% on imported drones and their components, escalating efforts to reduce US reliance on foreign suppliers and potentially accelerating a decoupling of drone supply chains with China. The top rate will apply to heavier drones — weighing more than 25 kilograms — or those that possess certain capabilities. The White House said Thursday. Smaller drones will be taxed at 25%, while lower rates apply to some trading partners such as the European Union and Japan.

The statement didn’t mention China, but the tariffs risk reinforcing a two-way separation with the world’s dominant drone manufacturer already under way. They also add to a drumbeat of tit-for-tat measures just weeks before Chinese leader Xi Jinping is expected to meet with President Donald Trump in the US. “In the long term, we’re probably slipping towards an outcome of a hard decoupling for at least certain types of drones,” said Christopher Beddor, deputy China research director at Gavekal Dragonomics. “I

think this is part of a broader pattern in which both the US and China uphold their basic trade agreement but continue to take relatively low-grade actions against each other.” US restrictions on new foreign-made models last year have curbed Chinese access to the American market, while Beijing has tightened scrutiny of drone-related exports to the US. Chinese drone exports to the US fell to about \$50 million in the first half of this year, roughly half the level recorded a year earlier, according to Chinese customs data. **Bloomberg**

LUX

LUX INDUSTRIES LIMITED

CIN : L17309WB1995PLC073053

Regd. Office: 39, KALI KRISHNA TAGORE STREET, KOLKATA - 700 007

Email: info@luxinnerwear.com, Website: www.luxinnerwear.com, Ph: 033-40402121, Fax: 033-40012001

Promises and performances that ensure comfort

EXTRACT OF UN-AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30TH JUNE, 2026

PARTICULARS	STANDALONE			CONSOLIDATED		
	Quarter Ended		Year Ended	Quarter Ended		Year Ended
	30.06.2026 (Un-audited)	30.06.2025 (Un-audited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	30.06.2026 (Un-audited)	30.06.2025 (Un-audited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)
Total income from operations (net)	622.72	613.55	2961.76	616.50	613.39	2960.82
Net Profit / (Loss) before exceptional items and tax	29.15	31.15	139.00	30.27	30.48	143.62
Net Profit / (Loss) after exceptional items before tax	29.15	31.15	132.89	30.27	30.48	137.51
Net Profit / (Loss) after tax attributable to the owners of the Company	21.98	23.92	101.45	23.10	23.25	106.07
Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	21.98	23.92	102.89	23.10	23.25	107.51
Equity Share Capital (Face value Rs. 2/- per share)	6.26	6.26	6.26	6.26	6.26	6.26
Other Equity excluding Revaluation Reserve	-	-	1841.69	-	-	1827.78
Earnings Per Share (Basic & Diluted in Rs.) (Face value Rs. 2/- per share)*	7.31	7.95	33.74	7.36	7.84	34.52

* Not Annualised except for the year ended 31st March, 2026.

Notes :

1. The above results have been reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on August 14, 2026.

2. During the year ended March 31, 2026, the Company had recognised an incremental impact of Rs. 2.76 Crores towards employee benefit obligation, arising from changes in the wage definition under the New Labour Codes, and an entry tax demand of Rs. 3.35 Crores pertaining to earlier years settled under the West Bengal Settlement of Dispute (SOD) Act, 2025, which were disclosed as exceptional items.

3. Pursuant to a Family Settlement Agreement among the promoter group, the Board of Directors of the Company, at its meeting held on 23 April 2026, has accorded its in-principle approval for a proposed Scheme of Demerger, whereby the business undertakings of Vertical A and Vertical C are proposed to be demerged into two separate Wholly Owned Subsidiaries of the Company, namely Lux and Cozi Limited and Lux Global Limited, and business of Vertical B shall continue in the Company. As the proposed Scheme of Demerger is currently at a preliminary stage, and pending finalisation and consequential filing with the concerned regulatory authorities for their necessary approvals, no effect has been given in these financial statements.

4. The figures for the three months ended March 31, 2026, are arrived at as the difference between audited figures in respect of full financial year and the unaudited published year-to-date figures up to December 31, 2025, being the date of the end of the third quarter of the financial year which were subject to limited review.

5. The above is an extract of the detailed format of un-audited Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Un-audited Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange website (www.bseindia.com) and on the Company's website (www.luxinnerwear.com).

By Order of the Board for LUX INDUSTRIES LIMITED

Sd/-

Ashok Kumar Todi

Chairman

DIN-00053599

Place : Kolkata

Date : August 14, 2026

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Tata Steel to Sell Football Club to Churchill Bros FC



Online Bureau

Mumbai: Tata Steel will sell its wholly owned football subsidiary, Jamshedpur FC, to Goa-based Churchill Brothers Football Club for a token consideration of ₹100, the company said on Friday.

The team had a turnover of ₹32.23 crore in fiscal 2026, and a negative net worth of ₹5.8 crore. It accounted for 0.01% of the company's consolidated turnover. Tata Steel will sell its entire 40.8 million equity shares in Jamshedpur Football & Sporting.

The sale of Jamshedpur Football & Sporting will include the transfer of the club's Indian Super League (ISL) sporting licence, 12 players and two coaches. A few days ago, Jamshedpur FC had withdrawn from the ISL.

The deal is expected to be completed by the end of the month.

"Churchill Brothers is a club with real history in Indian football, and we are glad that this agreement gives our players and coaches the opportunity to continue playing club football," said DB Sundara Ramam, vice president for corporate services.

The company said that they would continue to focus on football at the grassroots and youth level, and will repurpose it for football at a grassroots level and athlete development.

Tata Football Academy, established in 1987 at Jamshedpur, has had 150 players representing the Indian National team. Apart from football, Tata Steel has academies for archery, hockey, sport climbing and rowing.

MakeMyTrip Ties Up with Govt to Offer Guided Tours

Our Bureau

New Delhi: MakeMyTrip (MMT) has partnered with the tourism ministry to roll out more than 350 guided tours across more than 60 cities in the country. The tours can be booked on the online travel platform coinciding with Independence Day on Saturday, and the catalogue would be developed further.

MMT said the partnership is aligned with the vision of "Incredible India" and "Dekho Apna Desh", and that the tie-up is aimed to inspire Indians to travel and experience the country's diversity across its heritage, culture, spirituality, cuisine, festivals and monuments, along with expert guides.

Tourism minister Gajendra Singh said that guides, local experts and communities are the backbone of India's tourism value chain. "This partnership gives them an opportunity to reach travellers directly and share India's stories," he said.

Trump-Branded Resort Delays Digital Token Plan

Bloomberg

World Liberty Financial and its partners have delayed plans to sell a digital token tied to a Trump-branded resort in the Maldives, putting on hold one of the more ambitious projects in the crypto venture's push to bring real-world assets onto the blockchain.

The token, which would give investors a share of revenue from loans financing the resort, was supposed to go on sale this spring. The offering has been pushed back as the war with Iran disrupts travel, people familiar with the matter said. The Maldives project, being developed by UK-based Dar Global Plc, was meant to be an early showcase for World Liberty's ambitions beyond conventional digital assets.

Over the past year, the company co-founded by US President Donald Trump and his sons has discussed tokens tied to everything from real estate and investment funds to oil and gold, people familiar with the matter said. "Dar Global continues to advance its partnership with the Trump Organization," chief executive officer Ziad El Chaar said. "We consistently evaluate the development and roll-out schedules of our global portfolio to ensure they align with market conditions, regulatory requirements, and our long-term strategic objectives."

Kohler to Take India's Maximalism Global

The bathware giant plans to invest at least \$100 million in India over the next decade as affluence, urbanisation and premium housing fuel demand

Sagar Malviya

Mumbai: Indians prefer splashy bathrooms to the minimalist designs favoured in some other countries, said David Kohler, chairman and CEO of Kohler Co., citing a key learning in the market that the 154-year-old bathware firm views as the most significant besides its home base in the United States.

"Here, it's trending a little more towards maximalism," he told ET in an exclusive interview, highlighting a contrast between India and some European markets.

Indian consumers are more willing to experiment with shape, colour and finish, he said, adding that a product tailored for India may be larger, with more design detail, or have a more flamboyant shape than something created for a market where restrained minimalism is preferred.

About 70% of the company's India sales now come from products designed specifically for local consumers, with more expressive shapes, colours and finishes. A bathroom is increasingly becoming a canvas for self-expression, Kohler said, and the company is betting that increasing incomes, bigger homes and an appetite for luxury will make that canvas even larger. This localisation is increasingly feeding back into Kohler's global business. Products and technologies developed in India are being taken to other markets, including a shoulder shower and flushing technologies.

Unlike some markets where consumers may prefer bathrooms to disappear into the architecture, Indian consumers appear increasingly happy to make them part of the statement, said David Kohler, chairman & CEO, Kohler Co.

For him, the difference is not just cosmetic. The Indian bathroom itself behaves differently. Hygiene sprays, for instance, are deeply embedded in Indian bathrooms, where the wet area is more pronounced than in markets such as the US. Kohler expects that to evolve as bidets, bidet seats and smart toilets gain ground.

The company sees smart toilets and bidets eventually replacing some of that functionality as Indian consumers become more comfortable with newer bathroom technology. The

ir starting point, however, is different from that of consumers in Japan, China or the US, where bidets and smart toilets have a much lower barrier to adoption.

GREEN LIGHTS

The company, headquartered in Kohler, Wisconsin, with annual revenue of about \$6 billion, expects India to become its second-largest market within the next decade. It does not disclose country-level revenue but said India is already among its top five markets.

India's appeal goes beyond bathrooms. Kohler sees the country's rapid urbanisation, real-estate development and growing affluent population as a long-term growth engine. The company is particularly tied to high-rise residential projects, hospitality and redevelopment, all of which are expanding the addressable market for premium bathroom and kitchen products. Kohler's confidence is reflected in the company's manufacturing plans. It has invested hundreds of millions of dollars in India over the past 20 years and plans to invest at least another \$100 million over the next decade. Its plant near Bharuch in Gujarat is being expanded with new technology and capabilities.

Asked what could discourage him from investing further in India, he said unequivocally, "I don't see a lot of red flags or caution flags today in India."

Kohler pointed to the country's broad-based economic growth and said India does not face some of the demographic challenges weighing on other markets. "We think it's all flashing green right now," he said.

INDIA RISING

The company makes most of what it sells in India locally, with only a small proportion imported, mainly specialised products that have not yet been industrialised in the country. Local manufacturing allows Kohler to be more cost competitive while delivering what it sees as higher value to consumers.

India is also becoming a production base for the world. About 10% of the company's output is currently exported, Kohler said, and the company would like to increase that over time. The priority, however, remains the domestic market, with about 80% of production expected to remain focused on India.

Tariffs could threaten to thwart that ambition. Kohler said the company's facilities in the country were built not only to serve local consumers but also to take advantage of 'Make in India' and supply products to other markets.



MAKING A STATEMENT

Unlike some markets where consumers may prefer bathrooms to disappear into the architecture, Indian consumers appear increasingly happy to make them part of the statement, said David Kohler, chairman & CEO, Kohler Co.

Order it. Pack it. Deliver it

Qcomm cos Plan to Bring Home Your Large Electronics Orders in 30 mins

Writankar Mukherjee

Kolkata: Large appliances such as refrigerators, televisions, washing machines, and microwave ovens may get a sales fillip as quick commerce companies Swiggy, Blinkit, and Amazon's Zomato, among others initiate talks with their manufacturers to enter the segment, according to four industry executives.

Incumbents Flipkart, Amazon, and Reliance Retail's JioMart are also pushing to shorten delivery times for large appliances. Walmart-owned Flipkart has piloted two-hour delivery of large appliances in about a dozen cities, with installation included in certain cases, handled by in-house teams. Until now, most such deliveries took a day or more, with same or next day delivery available only in select locations.

"Quick-commerce sales would require service coordination for faster installation of products," said Sanjay Chitkara, director at LG Electronics India. He said some

Instant Living

Online contribution to total sales for TV and household appliances varies from 15% to 45%

Flipkart has started 2 hour delivery of large appliances in 12 cities

E-commerce cos now want a wider portfolio to offer for fast deliveries

Quick commerce did not begin for appliances till now due to logistic issues

Electronic cos say challenge is faster installation matching delivery speed

operators, including Swiggy, had approached the company and that it was evaluating the opportunity. Kamal Nandi, business head (appliances) at Godrej Enterprises Group, said some e-commerce platforms, including Flipkart and Amazon, were looking at two-hour delivery across their product ranges. "We can try same-day installation in certain pin codes," he said. "E-commerce is becoming an important channel."

E-commerce and quick-commerce companies had previously experimented with rapid delivery of large appliances, but with limited assortments and little success. Blinkit, for instance, launched 10-minute delivery of Lloyd air conditioners in Delhi-NCR last year, with plans to expand to other cities. The service however failed to generate significant demand.

So far, faster deliveries have largely remained confined to "grab-and-go" products such as mobile phones, laptops, tablets, headphones

A YOUNG NEW WORLD

For Gen Z, Freedom at Work is a Must-Have, Not a Perk

Young want more say in how they work and build their careers, making cos rethink

Sreeradha Basu & Brinda Sarkar

Bengaluru: For Gen Z, workplace freedom is no longer just a perk. It is becoming an expectation, with young employees seeking greater say in how they work, what they work on and how their careers progress.

The shift is taking different forms across companies: Deutsche Bank is focusing on flexible working and career mobility; InMobi on outcome-led performance and cross-functional opportunities; Emeritus on continuous learning; RPG Enterprises on remote work and greater career transparency; and Schneider Electric on internal mobility and AI-enabled skills development.

Across companies, the broader trend is towards giving employees more choice in how they work and deliver, while keeping accountability firmly in place.

"For many Gen Z professionals, freedom at work goes beyond flexibility in location or working hours. It is increasingly about having a voice, being trusted to take ownership and contributing meaningfully to outcomes," said Madhavi Lall, head-HR India, Deutsche Bank Group.

Organisations are increasingly listening—and learning. Emeritus is speaking to more than 1,000 Gen Zs across India, including talent already in the workforce, for an upcoming report. One early finding is that nearly three in four prioritise work-life balance over formal leadership titles.

"Gen Z does not leave organisations, they leave managers. That insight has shaped where we invest," said Ganesh S. CHRO at Emeritus.

He said ambiguity creates anxiety for this cohort, prompting Emeritus to become more deliberate about performance expectations, decision-making and realistic growth paths. The company has also shifted



COS ADAPT

The broader trend is towards giving employees more choice in how they work, while keeping accountability firmly in place



OPEN DEMAND

Every generation has wanted more control over its time. Gen Z is simply much more comfortable asking for it upfront

from annual surveys to continuous listening through skip-levels, pulse checks and informal feedback channels. At InMobi Group, Gen Z comprises more than 38% of the workforce, including interns, reshaping its approach to high-performance cultures.

"We view our mandate not as prescribing career paths, but as enabling individual capability," said Shefali Rai, group CHRO, InMobi and Glance.

Its SuperYou framework supports development, while Live Your Potential offers cross-functional bridge assignments to help talent test new domains and build multi-dimensional skillsets. More than 15% of InMobi's open roles are filled through internal mobility.

"When you give ambitious talent the freedom to experiment, paired with the responsibility to deliver, you don't just retain Gen Z, you create a resilient, self-driven workforce," said Rai.

Research by RPG Enterprises found that 64% of Gen Zs cited flexible work options as a workplace must-have.

"Every generation has wanted more control over its time. Gen Z is simply much more comfortable asking for it upfront," said Udayan Dutt, president-group HR at RPG Enterprises.

But freedom for Gen Z goes much further, said Dutt. It is autonomy over how a problem gets solved, not just when. It is having a voice in the work they take on, the skills they build and the direction in which they grow.

"The policies at RPG reflect this—flexible working hours, remote work options, structured mentorship, progressive benefits and continuous learning platforms," Niharika Mohan, CHRO, Greater India Zone, Schneider Electric, said the company puts employees in the driver's seat of their careers.

"Through our AI-powered Career Hub, we give people greater transparency on their skills, career paths and opportunities. Mentoring, projects and internal mobility enable employees to explore different roles, build networks and gain experiences."

However, freedom at work cannot mean freedom from accountability, managers said.

"The framework is simple but quite critical—be clear about the outcome, the deadline, the dependence is non-negotiable—then give people appropriate freedom over how they get there. This also makes autonomy more inclusive," said Emeritus' Ganesh.

Colleges Bet on 'Influencer' Majors; Critics ain't Happy

Varsities are rolling out degrees intended to prepare students for today's careers

Associated Press

Ask a teen what they want to be when they grow up, and there's a fair chance being an influencer is on their list.

Digital media and the people who star in it have been cultural mainstays for teens' entire lives, so creating social media, video or podcast content seems a natural, albeit nontraditional, career path. And now they can earn a college degree in that very field.

Arizona State University (ASU) recently launched a new bachelor's degree in content creation, offered through its Walter Cronkite School of Journalism and Mass Communication. The curriculum overlaps with that of ASU's mass communication and media studies degree, with the major departure being a slate of specialised electives on podcasting, studio production and on-camera presence.

ASU's announcement was met with swift criticism from many sides—from people who feel content creation is not a legitimate profession to those who question the value of a college degree in launching a social media career. But the ASU programme is not the first of its kind.

And the university, which declined an interview request about the new programme, is not the first to offer content creation courses.

Universities, eager to compete for a shrinking student population, are rolling out new majors intended to prepare students for today's careers. Whether they lead to jobs can be up for debate.

Many higher education institutions have started offering classes focused on the burgeoning content creation industry over the past couple years, and several have certificate or minor programmes. Syracuse University, Quinnipiac University and Colorado State University offer minors, and St Bonaventure University announced a content creation major last winter.



To Brooke Erin Duffy, a communication professor at Cornell University, these college programmes represent an inflection point. During the past year, Duffy said, institutions in education and beyond have been acknowledging content creation as a viable career path—even if the term "influencer" itself feels a nerve.

On social media, influencers are everywhere, sharing shopping recommendations and lifestyle content or promoting beliefs about health or politics. Because even influencers with relatively small followings have loyal audiences, brands also often pay them to talk about products.

The image of a prototypical influencer, Duffy said, is usually a "young girl who is snapping selfies and just reaping in tremendous rewards for seemingly not doing anything."

But that's not the reality for many content creators, who are working on media production, audience retention strategies, brand partnerships and business relationships associated with their online presence.

"It is a time-consuming, labour-intensive job that often doesn't pay well—at least in the beginning," Duffy said. "But a lot of that gets concealed behind... this assumption that it's a dream job."

Even if someone has the skills to make it in content creation, it isn't easy to break in. Social media is already a crowded

field, and it's going to get even more competitive in the coming years, said Max Willens, a principal analyst at Emarketer who covers the creator economy.

Emarketer forecasts that social media creator revenue in the US will climb above \$20 billion this year, but Willens said it's important to contextualise what that means for individual creators.

"The overwhelming majority of that money is not going into creators' pockets," he said, even though their content and their followers form the foundation of the lucrative field.

Influencers can earn money from social media platforms, which reward high engagement, and some earn commission if people buy a product they're promoting. But the largest share of influencers' earnings comes from sponsored content—getting paid to talk about a brand or product.

Willens said he expects the amount brands spend distributing and amplifying creator content will eventually surpass the amount creators earn making it.

The idea that a specialised college degree will "suddenly turn people into viral content machines" deserves a bit of a reality check, Willens said. Duffy noted that to get rich quickly, colleges that introduce content creation degrees may be hoping to attract new students—and their parents—who are looking for "a job that will pay off," Duffy said. "Whether or not it does is another story."

Market Trends

STOCK INDICES		% CHANGE
Nifty 50	24366	-0.12
S&P Sensex	78009	-0.09
MSCI India	1596	-0.20
MSCI EM	4720	0.48
MSCI BRIC	729	-0.56
MSCI World	24252	0.10
Nikkei	68714	0.59
Hang Seng	25117	-1.10
Kospi(S.Korea)	6978	2.42
Straits Times	5744	0.41

OIL (\$/BRL)	
DUBAI CRUDE	78.86
	0.38
Absolute Change	

GOLD FUTURES		Premium/Discount (\$/-78.19)
Comex US (\$/Oz)		MCX India (₹/10Gm)
OPEN	4408.20	153200.00
LAST*	4423.20	153693.00
Prev chg (%)	0.06	0.15

FOREX RATE (₹/\$ Exchange Rate)	
OPEN	95.36
LAST	95.44

At 6 pm IST Source: Bloomberg, MCX, ETIG

Market on Twitter @ETMarkets

Contrary to Governor's Remarks

From Page 1

The facility, operationalised on June 8 to boost dollar inflows and strengthen foreign exchange reserves, allows banks to swap eligible overseas borrowings with the central bank at concessional rates, significantly lowering their cost of funds. Banks can swap FCNRB(B) with the RBI under a zero-cost hedging facility available until September 11. Total foreign inflows from the special measures announced by the RBI stood at \$56.84 billion until August 13, up from \$40.81 billion reported as of July 31. FCNRB(B) deposits accounted for most of the inflows at \$52.30 billion.

Dollar inflows from ECBs and OFCBs were comparatively modest at \$1.74 billion and \$2.80 billion, respectively, RBI data showed.

Inflows through the FCNRB(B) scheme have exceeded the \$26 billion mobilised under a similar scheme in 2013, less than two months after the latest window opened on June 8.

The early closure of the swap window contrasts with RBI governor Sanjay Malhotra's comments after the monetary policy review on April 5, when he said the central bank neither planned to prematurely close the swap window because of robust inflows nor had it received any proposal to extend the timeline beyond the announced deadline.

Forex Reserves Rise by \$14 b to Hit \$707 b

Our Bureau

Mumbai: India's foreign exchange reserves rose \$14.1 billion to \$707 billion in the week ended August 7, the highest total reserves in this fiscal year. The increase in reserves comes

Earnings to give stock-specific triggers; broader indices look better placed, say analysts

D-St Ends in Red for a 3rd Week on W Asia Deal Delay, Oil Spike

Our Bureau

Mumbai: India's equity indices ended lower on Friday at the end of a lacklustre trading week, as continued geopolitical uncertainty and an upswing in crude oil prices weighed on Dalal Street.

NSE's Nifty fell 29.85 points, or 0.1%, to close at 24,366. BSE's Sensex declined 70.71 points, or 0.1%, to end at 78,009.25. The indices declined 0.8% and 0.6% for the week, respectively, after two straight weeks of losses.

"Benchmark indices remained subdued this week as the US-Iran deal, which was expected last weekend, was deferred again," said Siddhartha Khemka, head of research at Motilal Oswal Financial Services. "Oil prices spiked after the delay, adding pressure on Indian equities."

Brent crude oil October futures were trading above \$88 a barrel on Friday evening and remained elevated through the week, compared with their close of \$83.5 a barrel last Friday.



Re Closes Flat, RBI Likely Intervened

MUMBAI The rupee was largely unchanged on Friday, closing at 95.42 to the US dollar, against its previous close of 95.44. The central bank was present in the market throughout the week, with frequent dollar-selling interventions to curb declines. There was constant dollar demand from importers and oil companies. — Our Bureau

traded on Friday, 1,896 advanced and 2,393 declined at the close. The midcap index gained 0.2% for the week, while the Smallcap 250 fell 0.4%.

Technically, Nifty is hovering around the confluence zone of its 100-day and 200-day Exponential Moving Averages (EMA), said Vipin Kumar, AVP - Derivatives and Technical Research at Globe Capital Market.

Kumar said Nifty's immediate support lies around the 24,130-24,000 spot levels, while resistance is at 24,620-24,700.

"A decisive breakout above 24,700 is essential to trigger a sustainable rally toward 24,850 and higher levels, while a breach below 24,000 (which appears less probable) could drag the index down to 23,800-23,600," he said. "Given the current chart structure and a lack of fresh triggers, we expect Nifty to remain range-bound within the 24,000-24,700 zone short term."

Khemka said overall earnings breadth has improved, with outperformance seen in the broader market. "While Nifty50 earnings growth has remained steady, the mid- and small-caps have delivered stronger growth and could remain better placed going ahead," he said.

Elsewhere in Asia, Japan gained 0.6% and South Korea rose 2.4%, while China ended flat. Hong Kong fell 1.1%, while Taiwan dropped 0.5%. The pan-European Stoxx 600 was flat at the time of going to print.

Foreign portfolio investors net bought shares worth ₹508 crore. Domestic institutions were buyers to the tune of ₹356 crore.

Aimed at End-to-end Indian Capability

From Page 1

RIL has also acquired stakes in several defence startups and companies.

The partnership also entails RIL and Rolls-Royce exploring the establishment of a dedicated aerospace gas turbine complex as a centre of excellence for power and propulsion technology.

"The partnership will offer a compelling proposition for joint development of the AMCA engine in India, bringing together world-leading technology and industrial execution capabilities," according to the statement. The partnership is aimed at building end-to-end Indian capability covering the design, development, manufacturing, testing, production, and through-life support of aero-engines, it said.

The RIL-Rolls-Royce partnership will face a major challenge from French manufacturer Safran, which has been shortlisted to develop next-generation fighter jet engines for the AMCA programme.

"India's strategic autonomy requires sovereign capability in critical technologies," said Anant Ambani, executive director, RIL. "Our intent with Rolls-Royce is to combine their world-leading expertise in advanced propulsion with Reliance's technology, manufacturing, scale and execution capabilities to build an indigenous aero-engine ecosystem in India."

The alliance underscores India's efforts to strengthen domestic capabilities in critical defence technologies and reduce dependence on imports. It is also aligned with the government's Atmanirbhar Bharat push to indigenise defence manufacturing and develop advanced propulsion capabilities within the country.

"Together, with our existing partnerships and capabilities in India, this marks a major milestone towards building a robust, self-reliant aerospace ecosystem in the country," said Tufan Erginbilig, chief executive at Rolls-Royce.

The proposed aero gas turbine complex could also create opportunities for wider collaboration in defence, civil aerospace, and new power and propulsion systems. The companies didn't disclose the proposed investment or timeline for setting up the complex.

ICICI Seeks to Raise \$1.45-b Loan from a BofA-led Consortium

CTBC, Mashreq, Mizuho and Singapore's UOB part of syndication with more likely to join

Joel Rebello

Mumbai: Private sector lender ICICI Bank is seeking to raise at least \$1.45 billion through a four-year loan from a consortium of banks led by Bank of America (BoFA), with participation from Taiwan's CTBC Bank, Dubai's Mashreq Bank, Japan's Mizuho Bank, and Singapore's United Overseas Bank.

The loan is likely to be priced at 110-115 basis points over the secured overnight financing rate (SOFR), with more banks expected to join the syndication, according to people familiar with the matter. ICICI Bank has the option to increase the loan size if demand is strong.

"BoFA is the lead book runner in the transaction and has already committed about \$1 billion, which will reduce depending on the demand from other banks to join the transaction," said one of the people cited above. "The loan was launched into syndication earlier this week, and more banks will likely join the process and make commitments in the next couple of weeks."

Term Sheet

Pricing at 110-115 bps over SOFR

Move follows peers SBI, PNB and HDFC

Proceeds to be used to provide leverage to FCNR(B) depositors

Indian banks are looking to raise foreign currency funds and use special swap window

Non-responsive Elevators, Ailerons

From Page 1

Airbus has not prescribed any pilot action for such a situation, as it considers simultaneous malfunction of all three hydraulic systems impossible.

While the captain is separately under scrutiny after testing non-negative for psychoactive substances, the initial assessment from the recorders does not indicate any human action as a cause of the incident.

Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB), which is investigating the incident, has already interviewed the pilots.

The A320 has three independent hydraulic systems — colour-coded Green, Blue and Yellow — designed so that failure of

one does not result in loss of aircraft control.

In the Air India flight, all three hydraulic gauges registered a pressure drop within one second, causing the elevators and ailerons to briefly stop responding to pilot commands.

The two ailerons, located on the outer parts of each wing, normally move in opposite directions — reducing lift on one side while increasing it on the other — to roll the aircraft left or right. The elevators, on the horizontal tail at the rear, control the aircraft's nose up or down.

In this case, the ailerons moved in the same direction, generating extra lift that pushed the aircraft's nose upward steeply without any pilot input.

Not Moving High Court for Relief

From Page 1

SDTT has no plans to approach the Bombay High Court for relief and will wait for the charity commissioner to grant relief to SRTT, officials close to the Trusts said. Tata Trusts and Tata Sons did not comment. Some trustees of Tata Trusts have approached the charity commissioner in their individual capacities seeking relief, officials said. The move is understood to stem from the view that SDTT cannot seek such relief on behalf of SRTT.

SRTT and SDTT together hold 51.54% of Tata Sons, with SRTT holding about 23.5% and SDTT about 28%.

The charity commissioner had issued the restraint under Section 36A(1) of the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act following complaints regarding the composition of the SRTT board and alleged non-compliance with Section 36A(2) of the Act.

The regulator had also directed the SRTT board to postpone its May 16 meeting and refrain from convening such meetings until submission of an Inspector's report.

Section 36A(2) deals with the permissible number of perpetual or life trustees on the board. A recent amendment to the law introduced a statutory cap on the number of perpetual trustees that can serve on a public trust board. Section 36A(1) empowers the commissioner to pass directions on a trust.

CHANDRASEKARAN'S POSITION

The uncertainty over the AGM has also brought into focus the position of Tata Sons chairman N Chandrasekaran, who is liable to retire by rotation.

Officials familiar with the Articles of Association said that if the Tuesday meeting cannot be validly constituted because of lack of quorum, Chandrasekaran would continue as a director until a valid AGM is held, at which his reappointment can be considered.

Prem Rajani, managing partner of law firm Rajani Associates, said that unless the Articles of Tata Sons expressly require the presence of representatives of SDTT and SRTT to constitute the quorum, under the Companies Act, Tata Sons may proceed with the AGM so long as the requisite quorum under the Companies Act is present.

SANJAY GANDHI POST GRADUATE INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES

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Investigation Revolving Fund (IRF)

e-Tender Notice

Online e-bids are invited in two-bid system (1) Technical bid & (2) Price bid from reputed & genuine manufacturers / authorized primary importers for following items for entering into Rate Contract. Installation of maintenance free equipment's at no cost basis against the purchase of reagents & consumables namely:-

(A). e-tender Notice

- 1) Fully Automated Chemiluminescence Immunoassay Analyzer, Department of Microbiology (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/3/2026-PGI IRF).
- 2) Fully Automated Chemiluminescence/ Electrochemiluminescence (CLIA / ECLIA) Analyzer, Department of Endocrinology (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/4/2026-PGI IRF).

(B). 2nd time Retender Notice (e-tender)

- 1) Fully Automated Flash Chemiluminescence Analyzer, Department of Microbiology (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/2/2026-PGI IRF).
- 2) Fully Automated / Semi-automated bench-top Osmometer, Department of Endocrinology (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/5/2026-PGI IRF).
- 3) Fully Automated Immunohematology Analyzer for compatibility testing, Department of Transfusion Medicine (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/6/2026-PGI IRF).
- 4) Fully Automated Immuno-hematology Analyzer for Red cell Serology, Department of Transfusion Medicine (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/7/2026-PGI IRF).
- 5) Portable DNA/RNA Sequencing System, Department of Nephrology (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/8/2026-PGI IRF).
- 6) Quantitative viral load platform for HCV RNA & HBV DNA, Department of Gastroenterology (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/9/2026-PGI IRF).
- 7) Fully Automated Biochemistry Analyzer, Department of Hepatology (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/10/2026-PGI IRF).
- 8) Fully Automated Immunostainer, Department of Pathology (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/11/2026-PGI IRF).
- 9) Fully Automated Chemiluminescence technology based system, Department of Hematology (Tender ref. no.: 153-201012/12/2026-PGI IRF).

The offer / bids submitted earlier by the bidders against advertisement no. 1/11/IRF/2026-27 will be treated as cancelled. Therefore those who have already submitted their offer / bid against advertisement no. 1/11/IRF/2026-27 are also requested to submit again their offer / bid with earlier proof of deposit of EMD as they are not required to deposit EMD again but they are required to deposit tender fee again.

New bidders are required to deposit online tender fee & EMD and enclose its proof in technical bid as per tender terms & conditions alongside their complete offer.

The detailed terms & conditions of the e-Tender Notice can be downloaded from e-Tender website: <https://etender.up.nic.in> from 17.08.2026. The last date of submission of offer / bid is 07.09.2026 at 16.00 hrs through online mode only. Tender fee & EMD are to be submitted online transaction as per terms & conditions mentioned in tender document. The Director reserves the sole right to accept or reject any bid partially or fully without assigning any reasons.

Advt. No.: I/39/IRF/2026-27

DIRECTOR



CENTUM ELECTRONICS LIMITED

Corporate Identity Number (CIN): L8510KA1993PLC013869

Regd. Office: No. 44, KHB Industrial Area, Yelahanka New Town, Bengaluru - 560064

Phone: +91-80-41436000 Fax: +91-80-41436005

Email: investors@centumelectronics.com Website: www.centumelectronics.com

Extract of the Unaudited Consolidated Financial Results for the First Quarter ended 30th June, 2026

Sl. No.	Particulars	Quarter ended		Year ended
		30-06-2026 (Unaudited)	30-06-2025 (Unaudited)	31-03-2026 (Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations	2,064.58	1,815.38	9,685.65
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (from continuing operations)	159.52	235.37	1,148.42
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (from continuing operations)	112.31	177.86	1,007.11
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (from discontinued operations)	942.69	(132.75)	(1,525.17)
5	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (for continuing and discontinued operations)	1,055.00	45.11	(518.06)
6	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	1,062.52	29.65	(586.86)
7	Equity Share Capital (Face value of Rs. 10 per share)	147.59	147.07	147.41
8	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year	-	-	3,284.69
9	Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 10/- each) (a) Basic : (b) Diluted :	71.47 71.47	3.96 3.96	(31.63) (31.63)

Notes:

1. Brief of unaudited Standalone Financial Results for the first quarter ended 30th June, 2026 is as follows:

Particulars	Quarter ended		Year ended
	30-06-2026 (Unaudited)	30-06-2025 (Unaudited)	31-03-2026 (Audited)
Total Income from Operations	2,070.91	1,880.24	9,888.72
Profit Before Tax	182.54	212.02	(1,029.19)
Profit After Tax	135.33	154.51	(1,170.50)

2. The unaudited Standalone and Consolidated financial results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee in their Meeting held on August 12, 2026 and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at their Meeting held on August 13, 2026.

3. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarter ended unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the quarter ended Standalone and Consolidated financial results are available on the websites of the stock exchanges www.nseindia.com, www.bseindia.com and on the Company's website www.centumelectronics.com.



For CENTUM ELECTRONICS LIMITED

Sd/-

Nikhil Mallavarapu

Joint Managing Director

DIN : 00288551

Place: Bengaluru

Date : August 13, 2026



Opening Act Without The Headliners

La Liga kicks off tonight, but Barcelona and Real Madrid will have to wait another week to begin their campaigns



TESTS PLAYED BY EACH COUNTRY*

HOW INDIA HAVE FARED IN 599 TESTS

WINS	LOSSES	DRAWS	TIES
186	188	224	1

ly tempted to hand Brar a Test debut. "But I think Prasad recently has been bowling the best that I have ever seen him bowl in red-ball cricket." The decision to play only two quicks is a tricky one: if Sri Lanka bat first and India are unlucky with an injury to one of their quick men, the game could well be decided then and there.

are playing in Bombay for example. I think it is a little bit closer to playing here where we have seen the spinners get good bounce.”

Gill also said that the ground being open, not boxed in by giant concrete stands, would play a part. “The wind sometimes plays a crucial part. As a batsman, even in team meetings we talk about how if you want to take on a spinner, you have to see if the wind is with you or against you,” said Gill. “You have to see how you can use those conditions in your favour rather than working against them.”

A lot is hanging in the balance as Gill leads India out in their 600th Test. And even which way the wind blows could have a say.

From the Indian camp's training session, it appeared that the playing eleven was more or less decided. Devdutt Padikkal is set for No. 3 while Dhruv Jurel down the order ensures that Sarfaraz Khan has to bide his time.

Shubman Gill
with Sri Lanka
captain
Dhananajaya
de Silva

A photograph of two cricket players, Shubman Gill (right) and Dhananajaya de Silva (left), holding the Ranji Trophy. Shubman Gill is wearing a white Indian cricket jersey with 'apollo TYRES' and 'adidas' logos, and a blue Indian cricket cap. Dhananajaya de Silva is wearing a white Sri Lanka cricket jersey with 'Sri Lanka Cricket' and 'adidas' logos. The trophy is a large, ornate silver cup with a red ribbon around it that says 'RANJI TROPHY'. The background is a blurred green field.

SQUAD Harmanpreet Kaur (C), Smriti Mandhana (VC), Shafali Verma, Bharti Fulmali, Deepti Sharma, Richa Ghosh (WK), G. Kamalini (WK), Arundhati Reddy, Prema Rawat, Radha Yadav, Sree Charani, Renuka Thakur, Nandni Sharma, Kranti Gaud, Pratika Rawal

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From ritual brews to colonial excise, India's intoxicants became taxable commodities, exposing contradictions of culture & control



Chanakya's Arthashastra mentions a dedicated superintendent of liquor who managed all production and sales, issuing strict licenses to private distilleries. The ancient Mauryan state imposed a 5% sales tax and toll on liquors, alongside additional excise levies. Furthermore, the government operated its own official taverns, con-



BERT'S LATEST ATTEMPT TO OBLITERATE SOCIAL MEDIA



Reshmi Dasgupta

Many people of my generation and older would recall or even possess that tiny symbol of thriftiness which these days is being hailed on the same plain — as environmental consciousness. Growing up, it was unthinkable to throw away clothes, just because a button fell off, a seam tore or a sock got a hole. All it required was a few red wax repair job by a family member and it was good as new. Even after multiple repairs, clothes were never discarded, they were

Crossword

ACROSS

1 They carry water in large amounts

5 Bird in this way seen around river by hotel (6)

9 Arrive to collect container for stewed fruit (7)

10 Ordinary woman, for one, rejected as too old (7)

11 Priest is well lit at intervals (3)

12 Fantastic athlete at site regularly, not after the time specified (2,3,6)

13 One in romantic meeting rated suspect (5)

14 Marginal place for fuel? (4,5)

Sustainable living has to privilege thrift over convenience, with personal effort

Mending has become a forgotten domestic accomplishment in India too as both schools and households have stopped teaching younger generations this basic life skill. I hated needlework classes at school, but they stood me in good stead. I have been the family mender and darning for years. Often sewing is also a therapeutic exercise, the repetitive movements of hemming or putting a fall on a saree always in-

ducing a meditative calmness. Maybe the women of yore thought so, too.

Needlework was thoughtlessly cut out of most school curricula around the world (including India) by the turn of the century, perhaps because it was perceived as sexist. But the outsourcing option to local tailors' masterjigs is still available here, so the 'crisis' of fast fashion gripping the West now has not impacted India as such. More so as we generally still prefer to mix and match rather than chuck clothes away.

However, it is hard to believe fast fashion brands that have opened repair units recently for customers in the West to get items mended are altruistic. When people enter a store to get garments repaired, what are the

chances they will buy some more too? Also, devising workshops to teach people how to sew buttons or fix tears are too few to make a dent in the mountains of clothes dumped in landfills or sent off to poor nations in the guise of "charity". Wasteful mindsets remain.

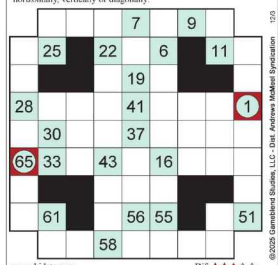
The way to truly save the planet is by restarting the inculcation of frugality, thrift and a respect for sustainable living, that too by teaching skills, not just mouthing platitudes. Any 'sexist' tags can be offset by ensuring all children, regardless of gender, learn to sew and darn—and iron and cook too—besides learning how to fix loose wires, tyres and hinges for that matter. And when the little kansha and tin sewing boxes pass on to the next generations, hopefully their ethos will too.



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Yesterday's puzzle solution.

				27	29	48			
	25	26	28	30	41	47			
	24	33	31	40	1	42	46		
23	22	32	34	39	2	43	45		
17	19	21	38	35	4	3	44		
18	16	20	36	37	7	5			
	15	14	12	9	8	6			
				13	11	10			

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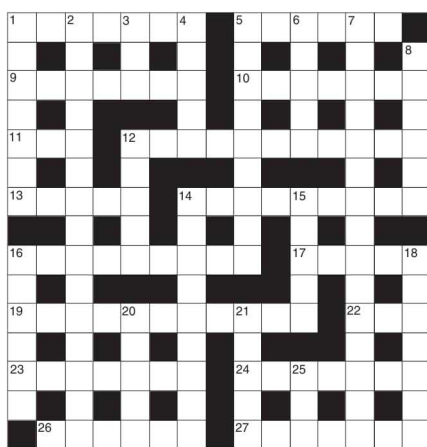
Find the 7 words to match the 7 clues. The numbers in parentheses represent the number of letters in each solution. In each solution, the letter combination can be used only once, but all letter combinations will be necessary to complete the puzzle.

CLUES	SOLUTIONS
1 easy to bend (7)	_____
2 dividing up (9)	_____
3 travel bag for a quick trip (9)	_____
4 full of oneself (7)	_____
5 finds a way around (11)	_____
6 1970s Ford (8)	_____
7 1970s Ford (6)	_____

GER	PLIA	SPL	UMV	ND
POM	MA	EKE	CK	ITTI
RI	NG	ENTS	BL	CIRC
WE	ALD	POUS	ERE	VE

Yesterday's Answers: 1. PUBLIC 2. PACERS 3. YAWNING

100%



ACROSS	
1 They carry water in large amounts (7)	16 Quiet official was wrong to be valued more highly (9)
7 In this way seen around river by hotel (6)	17 Note catches not opening recesses (5)
9 Arrive to collect container for stewed fruit (7)	19 Places in bay requiring renovation in an unavoidable way? (11)
10 Ordinary woman, for one, rejected as too old (7)	22 Fear hidden by outlaw, exceptionally ly (3)
12 It is well lit at intervals (3)	23 Late mob in a mess at fault (2,5)
12 Fantastic athlete at site regularly, not after the time specified (2,3,6)	24 Goes to lead involvement in work with solicitor about last of cases (4,3)
13 One in romantic meeting rated suspect (5)	26 Remove limits on payment increasing around end of October (4,2)
14 Marginal place for fuel? (4,5)	27 Some day for exercising dog (7)

DOWN

- 1 Journalist losing head in turn in final part? (4,3)
- 2 Treasurer, say, to pledge letter by one elected (9,6)
- 3 New mood intermittently in style of music (3)
- 4 Silver fish gave off an odour, we hear (5)
- 5 We hated do arranged and directed by pair of authorities (3,6)
- 6 A tree-eyed Indian woman (5)
- 7 Special expert somehow always keeps speaker in place for astronauts? (5,10)
- 8 Get very agitated in Kent area with most of number (6)
- 9 ...and engineering in time (5)
- 10 Spare cash to pour pile of discarded material (9)
- 11 Flower to pop up over year (5)
- 12 Tiny marks in cats' extremities (6)
- 13 ...to survey delect cooking with a pleasing aroma? (7)
- 20 Rub cold hands and freezing ears initially (5)
- 21 Bachelor facing depressing times in setbacks (5)
- 25 Brimless cap kept by past amateur (5)

SOLUTION TO NO. 9677:
ACROSS: 1 Over the hump.
 9 Deadpan. 10 Topped. 11 Ski.
 12 Scourge. 13 Morocco. 14 Noh.
 15 Audit. 17 Drift. 18 Bored.
 20 Video. 22 Sou. 24 Doleful.
 25 Actress. 26 Mob. 27 Gunwale.
DOWN: 2 Averted. 29 Theatregoer.
 1 On another planet.
 2 Emporia. 3 Tense. 4 Estimated.
 5 Umpired. 6 Police inspector.
 7 Odds-on. 8 Adroit. 16 Devilment.
 18 Bodega. 19 Deflate. 21 On the go.
 23 Upside. 25 Abate.

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